25901171- MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM MGU-UGP (HONOURS)

Answer Scheme

REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSECOM202

SOCIAL AND RURAL MARKETING (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Part A- 1 mark each

1. **Internal environment** refers to the factors within the company that can be directly managed or controlled.
2. **Positioning in social marketing** is the process of creating a distinct image or identity of a social cause or idea in the minds of the target audience.
3. **Concentrated targeting in a rural market** means focusing marketing efforts on a single, well-defined rural segment instead of the entire market.
4. **E-rural markets** connect producers and consumers through digital platforms (like online marketplaces), enabling direct selling, reducing intermediaries, and improving price realization for rural producers.
5. Two promotional tools used in Social Marketing campaigns are:
   Advertising, Public relations (or awareness campaigns) etc. (Any 2)
6. **Social Marketing** is the application of marketing principles to influence behavior for social good.
7. **Education as a social marketing tool** helps NGOs create awareness, change attitudes, and encourage desirable social behaviors through training, workshops, and information dissemination.
8. A **rural product** is a product designed to meet the needs, preferences, and conditions of rural consumers.
9. **Promotion mix in rural marketing** refers to the combination of communication tools such as advertising, personal selling, sales promotion, and publicity used to reach rural consumers.
10. One infrastructure-related factor affecting rural pricing is **transportation cost** (due to poor roads or connectivity). (Any 1)
11. **Medicare services** refer to healthcare services provided for the diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of diseases, including medical consultations, hospitalization, and related health facilities.
12. **Product adaptation in rural consumer durable marketing** means modifying or customizing products (like TVs, refrigerators, or farm equipment) to suit the needs, preferences, income levels, and usage conditions of rural consumers (e.g., low power consumption, durability, easy maintenance).

Part B- Any 5 questions- 8 marks each

13. **Targeting in rural marketing and its significance**

    Targeting in rural marketing refers to identifying and selecting specific groups of rural consumers based on factors like income, occupation, geography, and needs.

    Significance:

    - Helps in efficient use of resources
    - Enables better product customization.
    - Improves communication effectiveness
    - Increases market penetration and sales ***(2 marks for targeting and 6 marks for Any relevant 4 points of significance)***

14. **Impact of digital communication on rural banking and telecom promotion**

    Digital communication has significantly transformed promotional strategies in rural areas:

    Use of mobile phones and internet for direct communication SMS and

    app-based marketing for banking services

    Social media and digital ads for awareness

    Reduced cost of promotion compared to traditional media

    Faster dissemination of information and better customer engagement *(Any relevant pints shall be considered)*

15. **Focus of NGOs in maternal healthcare**

    NGOs primarily focus on:

    Providing prenatal and postnatal care awareness Promoting

    institutional deliveries

    Ensuring proper nutrition for mothers

    Reducing maternal and infant mortality

    Conducting health camps and vaccination drives (Any relevant 4 points with brief explanation)

16.

Basis	Commercial Marketing	Social Marketing
Objective	Profit maximization	Social welfare
Focus	Products/services	Behavior change
Target	Customers	Society/target groups
Outcome	Sales and revenue	Social improvement

17. **Common bases for segmenting a social marketing audience**

    - Demographic (age, gender, income)
    - Geographic (region, rural/urban)
    - Psychographic (attitudes, values, beliefs)
    - Behavioural (usage, awareness, habits)

18. **Challenges in developing and pricing rural products**

    Low purchasing power of rural consumers Poor

    infrastructure and transportation

Seasonal demand and income uncertainty Lack
of awareness and literacy
High distribution costs
Difficulty in setting affordable yet profitable prices *(Any relevant points shall be considered)*

19. **4 Ps in Social Marketing**

Product: Social idea, behavior, or service being promoted

Price: Cost (money, time, effort) required to adopt the behavior

Place: Channels through which the message/service is delivered

Promotion: Communication strategies used to spread awareness and influence behaviour.

Part C- Any 1 question- 20 marks

Note- The answer given for the case study is indicative- The student can follow different approaches- Consider the answers with explanation -

20. 4 marks each for each sub question.

(a) Social issue addressed

The social issue addressed in this case is **lack of access to safe and clean drinking water** in rural communities, along with poor hygiene awareness.

(b) Application of Cause-Related Marketing (CRM)

Cause-Related Marketing is applied by linking product sales with a social cause. In this case:

- The company donates **₹5 for every bottle sold**
- Funds are used for **rural water projects**
- Partnership with an NGO ensures implementation
- Promotion highlights that **each purchase contributes to the cause**
    - Thus, the campaign connects **consumer buying behavior with social impact**.

(c) Scope of CRM (any two areas)

Social development:

Supports rural communities by providing clean drinking water and hygiene awareness.

Brand building and customer engagement:

Enhances brand image and attracts socially conscious consumers, leading to increased sales.

(Other acceptable points: NGO collaboration, community welfare, corporate social responsibility etc.)

(d) Type of CRM and justification

The type of CRM used is **Transaction-based Cause-Related Marketing (or Purchase triggered) Justification:**

- Donation is directly linked to each product sale (₹5 per bottle)
- The contribution depends on consumer purchases

- Clear "buy-and-support" mechanism

(e) Two challenges of CRM highlighted in the case

1. **Lack of transparency:**
   Some consumers doubt how much of the money actually reaches beneficiaries.
2. **Short-term focus:**
   Consumers feel such campaigns should be long-term rather than temporary promotional activities.

21. Growth opportunities for Purple Lilly Ltd. (Any 4 points- 8 Marks)

PurpleLilly Ltd. has several growth opportunities in the floriculture market:

1. Increasing demand for flowers

Rising use in weddings, events, decorations, and religious purposes

Expanding urban and semi-urban markets

2. Government support

Policies promoting floriculture

Financial assistance and subsidies

Encouragement for women entrepreneurship in rural areas

3. Adoption of modern technology

Greenhouse cultivation improves quality and yield

Use of advanced farming techniques increases productivity

4. Expansion of digital platforms

Growth of online flower delivery services

Opportunity to reach wider markets through e-commerce

5. Export opportunities

Strong demand in nearby states like Tamil Nadu

Potential to expand to other regional and national markets

2. Challenges in marketing and distribution (Any 3 points- 6 Marks)

1. Perishability of flowers

- Very short shelf life leading to wastage

2. Seasonal demand fluctuations

- Demand varies based on festivals and occasions

3. Transportation issues

- Delays can reduce freshness and quality

4. Lack of standardization

- No uniform grading and packaging affects pricing and quality perception

5. Dependence on intermediaries

- Reduces profit margins and control over pricing

3. Strategies to improve supply chain and market position (Any 4 points- 6 Marks)

1. Cold storage facilities

- Establishing cold chains to extend shelf life and reduce wastage

2. Improved packaging and preservation

- Use of modern packaging techniques to maintain freshness during transit

3. Direct marketing channels

- Linking directly with retailers, event managers, and online platforms
- Reducing intermediaries

4. Branding and promotion

- Use of celebrity endorsements
- Building a strong brand image for quality flowers

5. Digital integration

- Selling through online platforms
- Using digital payments and marketing tools

6. Standardization practices

- Introducing grading and quality standards to ensure consistency